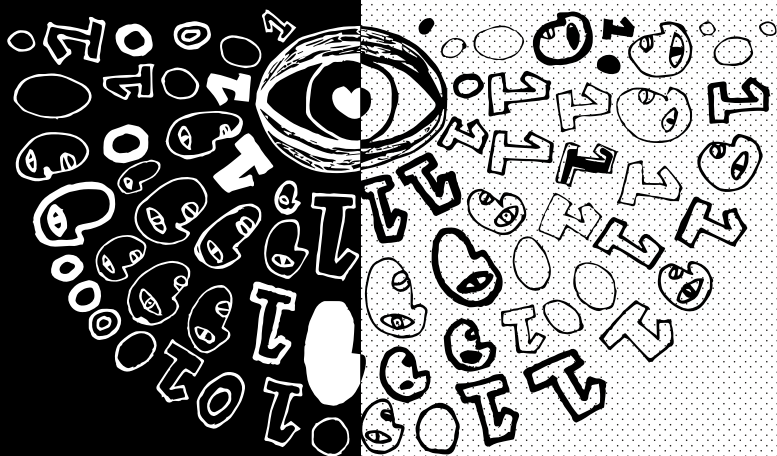


Sandro Asatiani

FROM CHAOS TO COSMOS



Sandro Asatiani

From Chaos to Cosmos



Sandro's Books
www.sandrosbooks.com

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www.sandrosbooks.com

ISBN: 9798275040906

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Foreword

Sandro Asatiani's book "From Chaos to Cosmos" is a collection of short stories, parables, I would say. It is a contemporary manuscript where, sometimes through hints, sometimes through direct indications, one finds phrases, images, and words that function as transit points into *terra incognita*, into digital territories, where no one has yet set foot, or where someone is already there and needs a psychogeographical, interactive guide, "hints," in order to find the "true teacher" or a safe path to the final round of a computer game, where countless secrets will be unveiled for them.

Life is somewhat like a computer game. The main hero's adventure, full of surprises, begins. He constantly has to make a choice. Each choice, in turn, is followed by a new surprise. No one knows

where the game will lead him, to an enlightened victory or an unexpected end.

Digital technologies, as never before, need their own, new *mythos*. Despite the fact that technologies are developing at the speed of light, we, humans, still live in the reality of ancient, unconscious archetypes. Sandro tries to discover these archetypes in the digital world and, if possible, to invent their new version, adapted to contemporary technologies. «Hevel havalim» — a creator of a creative advertisement says this phrase in passing, and we hear an echo from a text written thousands of years ago. In reality, the archetypes encoded in humanity's unconscious still function in our depths; the main thing is how we can use and manifest them in the new, digital world.

The title itself, "From Chaos to Cosmos," hints at something even more interesting: in ancient myths, from the primordial chaos (which in itself already contains potential cosmoses) — the cosmos (order) is, as a rule, created by cultural heroes or demiurges.

Those who study code today, who create digital worlds, chatbots, applications, and programs — they are precisely the young demiurges, little gods, who bring order to chaos in order to create a cosmos, a new order, from it.

Thus, this book is intended for these young demiurges.

All the unfulfilled dreams of alchemists or sorcerers are being created today on the keyboards of these demiurges. Incantations have been replaced by codes; esoteric Kabbalistic calculations by the mathematical power of computers; the revelations of angels (which in Greek means “messenger”) by chatbots and virtual reality; initiation practices by the encounter with the state “Leviathan”; meditations by computer games; deities by the virtual beings of artificial intelligence; temples by servers.

“Before the young sorcerer’s eyes, on the computer screen, the world he had created was depicted,” writes Sandro, deftly juggling ancient archetypes and ultra-modern technologies.

The main charm of the book is precisely this blending of ancient archetypes and humanity’s path toward technological singularity. The text, in every sentence, branches into several transit points where different treasures are stored. The mission of the contemporary demiurge or cultural hero is to create from the existing chaos that cosmos where we will all find ourselves in a completely new, unknowable reality, full of mysteries and revelations. At no stage in history have we had such illuminative, divine possibilities.

Young demiurge, do not be afraid of the snares and traps that social or cultural programming lays before you. Decipher this manuscript and dare to create something revolutionary, something great, something magical, that will change “reality” as we know it, because the time has come for the reality imposed on us to radically change, and for us to step into the world of technological magic. Everything is in your hands; the keyboard is at your fingertips.

And this book by Sandro Asatiani is a guide on this wondrous journey.

Zura Jishkariani



From Chaos to Cosmos

CHAOS

He pulled the pages from the folder and, in front of the colleagues gathered around him, began laying out the sketches on the table. He accompanied them with explanations. He told the story with such emotion that the sketches seemed to move and become an animation.

A young man appears in the frame, entering a market. Then we see everything through this person's eyes: shelves, countless packages of different colors, sizes, and forms. A human hand approaches one of the tin cans. The frame freezes. The tin can is seen in the frame.

Someone from the group gathered around the table asked:

— What's written on the can? — and read the inscription: *hevel havalim*.

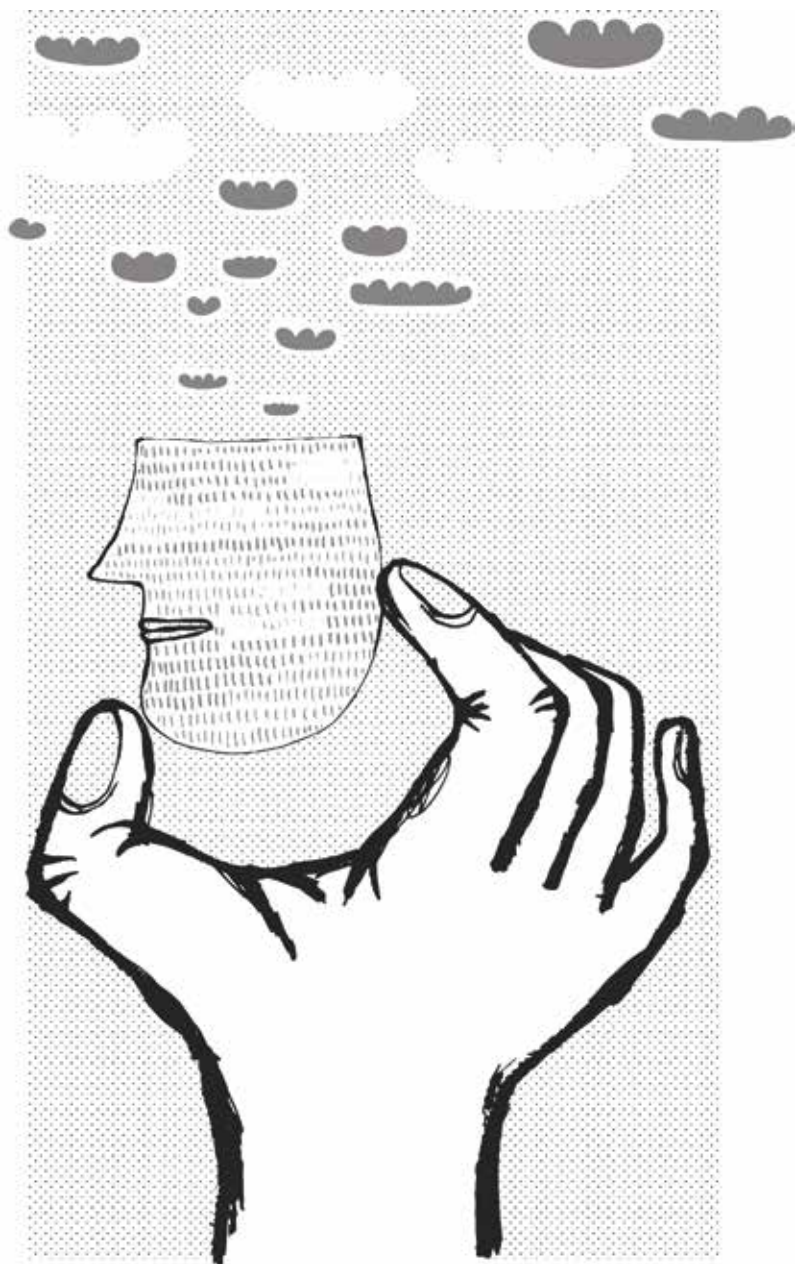
— It's just written conditionally. The first thing that came to my mind, I wrote it: *hevel havalim*. He looked over at those gathered around him, then lowered his head back to the pages spread on the table and continued:

The frames change quickly. The market cashier, a plastic bank card on the terminal, a receipt, a white polyethylene bag with green writing. A street, a building entrance, an apartment door, the entryway, the kitchen.

The same fellow appears in the frame, through whose eyes we were seeing the world. He places a pot on the stove. He opens the lid of the tin can bought at the store, the one provisionally labeled: *hevel havalim*.

From the tin can, he pours a transparent liquid into the pot, lights the stove, and peers into the pot.

Slowly, white, transparent clouds of steam are born in the liquid. The formless clouds join one another, or, conversely, break into parts. They move chaotically. They take on various curious forms and drift upward. Some clouds of steam grow, become transparent, and vanish into the



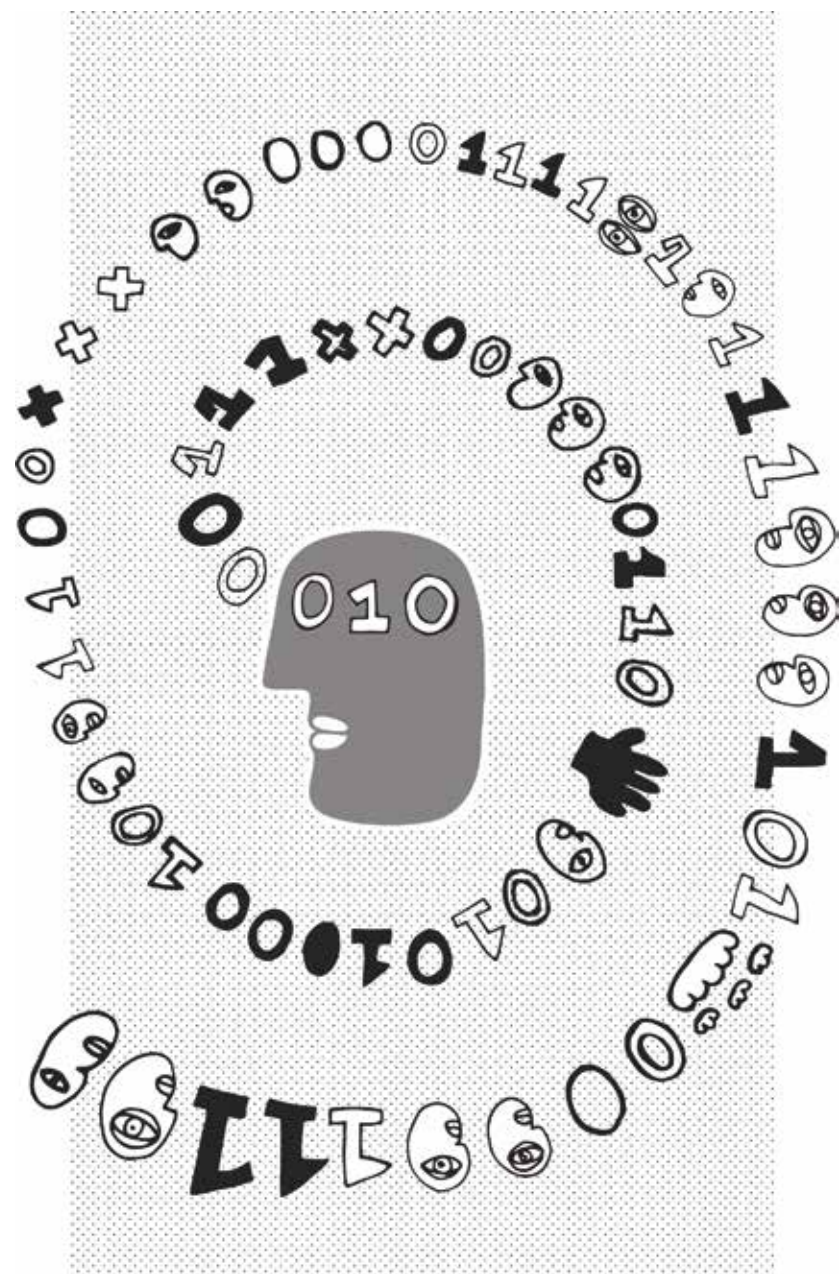
emptiness. One can gaze at the strange forms of the clouds endlessly.

The author of the sketches finished his explanations about the storyboarding and informed those gathered:

— Finished.

Silence fell. Various words were already spinning in the heads of most of those gathered around the table, but no one knew what to say. No one's thought was fully formed. When the client brought the order, it seemed he knew what he wanted. It seemed that everyone who worked on this project — the copywriter, the art director, the artist — had grasped something. It seemed that the one who had prepared the storyboarding wanted to say something with his work. It seemed that everything together represented an ordered cosmos, but, ultimately, everyone still had primordial chaos in their heads. Unformed thoughts moved like weightless clouds.

Many go with their own chaotic ideas to designers, to programmers — generally to those who can make, or assemble, something using technologies, and in return, they demand an assembled, functioning, orderly system, a cosmos. Such people apparently perceive those who work with technology as archaic gods who can create a



cosmos from chaos. Unfortunately, on the other side, there are few who have comprehended their mission, who can create an orderly, balanced whole from chaos.

No one knows what the client wants, or the boss, or the politicians on television, or the lecturers in the universities. Everyone has their own chaos in their head. They throw out words, individual phrases, unformed ideas, and then they wait to see what form the formless cloud of words will take, what interpretation their colleagues will give to what they said, how journalists will alter the story, how others will spread the story among friends. Students attend lectures, pass exams, and wait patiently to be taught how it is possible to create one's own cosmos from chaos.

COSMOS

In myths, just as in people's minds, everything begins with chaos. Before a thought takes form in the mind, formless clouds, imperceptible to consciousness, are formed at the bottom of consciousness. The clouds change form. They join one another. They grow and move upward, toward consciousness, or else, conversely, they dissipate into the void and vanish completely.

Those clouds that rise up to consciousness are formed into conscious thoughts. The everyday life of humans is an endless journey from the



formless embryos of thoughts to formed, realized ideas.

In today's chaos, though few in number, there are also those who, like archaic gods, can create a cosmos from chaos. And in this confused time of ours, when the old systems no longer work and new ones do not yet exist, humanity has placed its hope in them. They can arrange various scattered, jumbled elements in time and space. They can lend an understandable form to the clouds of unformed thoughts. True, digital technology is a new instrument that gives us new possibilities to cope with chaos, but what is decisive is still the one who will use this magical power correctly. Therefore, all that is left for us is to, as happened in pagan cultures, offer sacrifice to idols and perform rituals before them. Or to learn, or at least to try, to turn chaos into cosmos.



The Most Sexual Profession

JOURNEY INTO THOUGHTS

Zero, zero, zero, one, zero, one, zero... Ones and zeros replace one another. In the endless rows of zeros and ones, something seemed to take shape. A barely noticeable, elongated silhouette flashed by. Again, only ones and zeros... The zeros and ones redistributed, as if some figure flickered again in the rows of these digits. I think it must be the figure of a snake. It's a strange snake, two-headed. No, it's not two-headed, it's two snakes. They move rhythmically in the endless rows of zeros and ones. They entangle one another. They embrace one another. Their movement seems like a dance. No, this is something more, the love of snakes. The union of two opposite sexes.

This story is repeated from species to species:

from fish to reptiles, from dinosaurs to humans. Two principles: feminine and masculine, attraction, a love dance, contact, a sexual relationship. As a result, a new, unique life appears.

RETURN FROM THOUGHTS

He opened his eyes. When he opened his eyes, the thoughts, and the images accompanying the thoughts, scattered into the emptiness of the room. He was sitting at work again, at his own work desk. On the monitor, ones and zeros were still replacing one another, without any snakes.

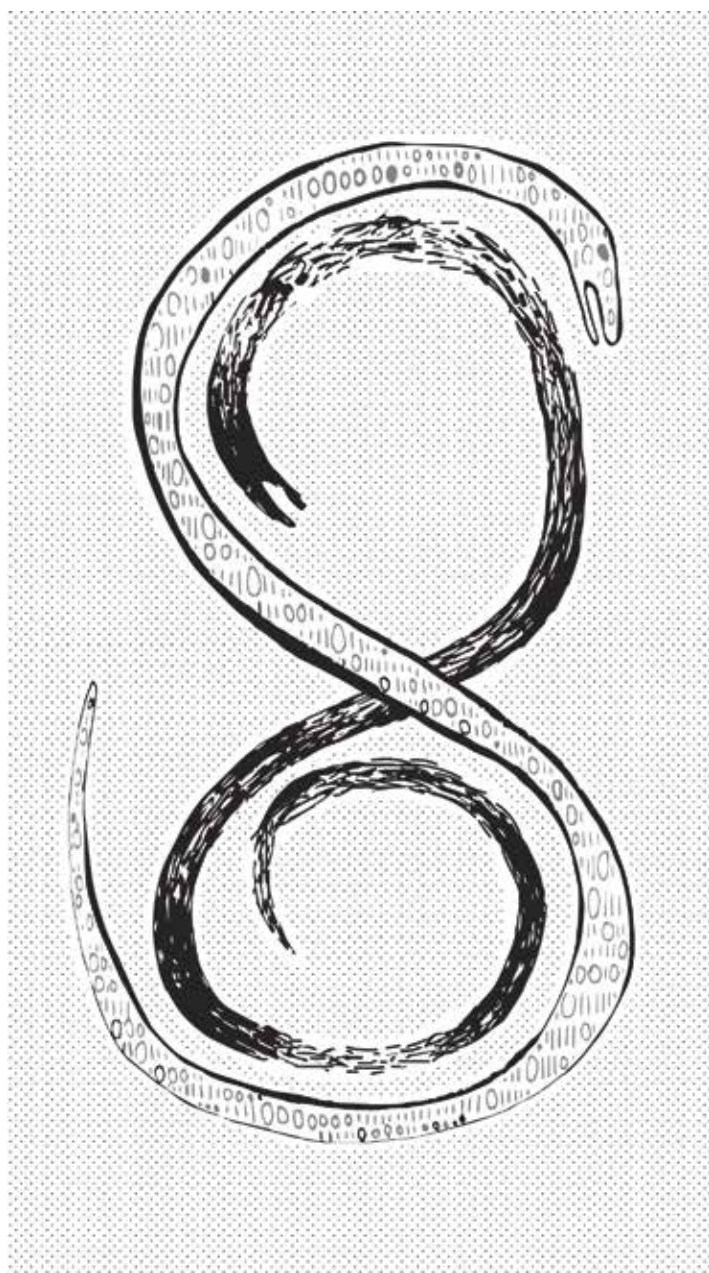
He looked around; he saw binary code everywhere. He had the feeling that he had glimpsed beyond existing reality and seen the code with which our reality is written.

From behind, he heard his friend's voice:

— Now don't tell me you can read something in those ones and zeros.

Our hero looked at him in surprise and turned back to the monitor. The friend saw this look and pointed at the computer screen.

The character smiled. "I've only seen a coder like that in *The Matrix*, the one who looks at the Matrix code and explains to Neo what kind of reality the program code is creating in the Matrix at that



moment.”

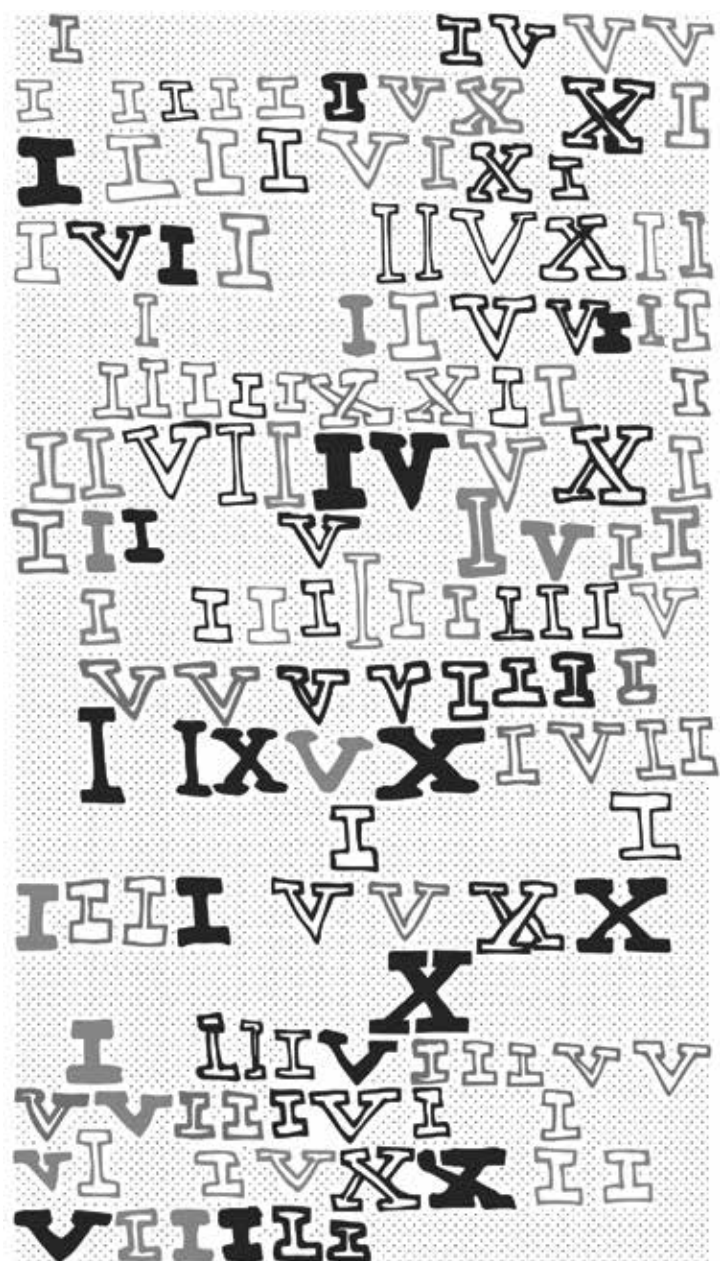
— So what do these ones and zeros want on your monitor? — the friend asked.

— Not just on the monitor, I see them everywhere now, — our character answered and continued, — When I close my eyes, I see this then, too. I saw one video on YouTube, and ever since, these zeros and ones have been haunting me.

— Which video? — the friend pressed.

He went on, and it was obvious that what they were talking about was not just some ordinary story found on the internet. It was clear that this topic had truly interested him:

— In this video, some fellow tells the history of digits, or more precisely, where the digits we use came from. The Greeks and Romans marked numbers with sticks and didn't need zero at all. One line meant one, two lines meant two. — Look, — the character continued and picked up a scrap of paper. With a pen, they drew three parallel lines on the paper: III. This is three. They had a separate symbol for five, and on the paper he drew a Roman five: V. Another for ten: X. Each number was a combination of these symbols, and that was it To write a large number in Roman numerals, you had to line up many sticks.



He started to write, but his friend interrupted:

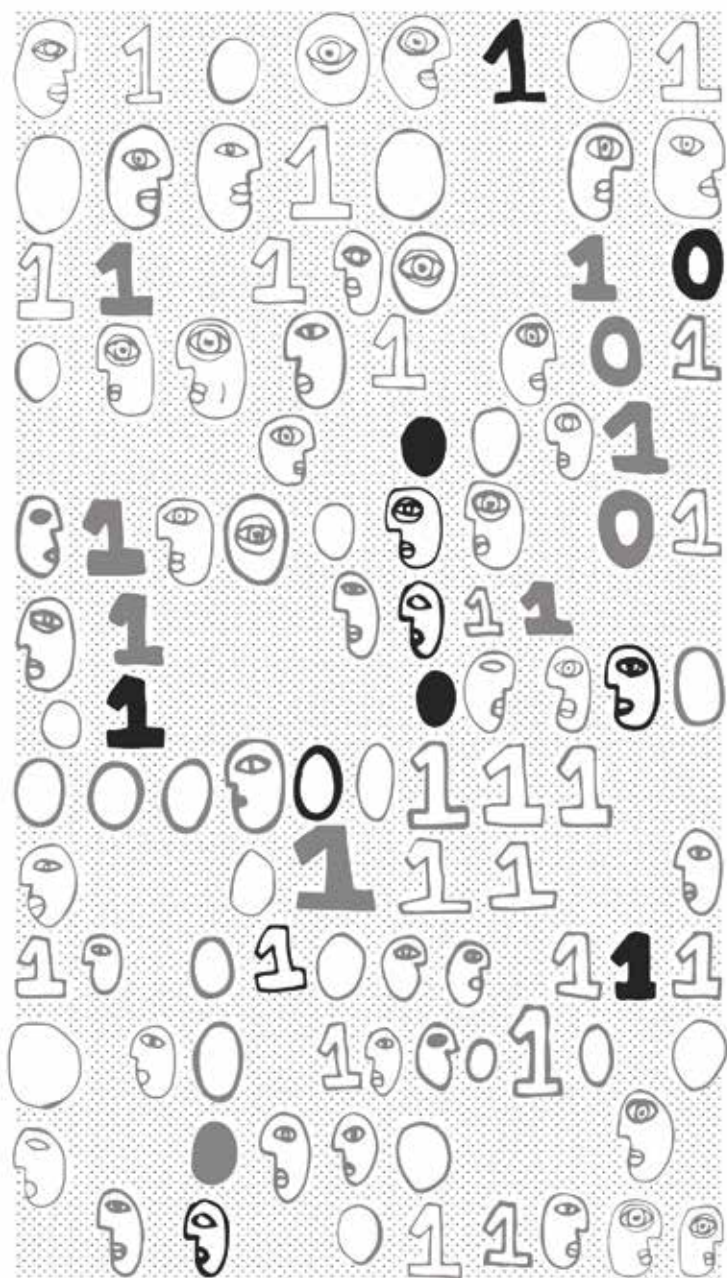
— I know that, but what's that got to do with zeros and ones?

— Well — he continued — is that later the Arabs introduced the digits we use now. That is, we now have ten Arabic digits of different shapes. Here, look. And under the Roman numerals, they jotted down ten symbols: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9. What's most important is that zero is mixed in with these. With their combination, you can write any number. But this zero isn't an Arab invention. They took it from India. It just wasn't called digits. The boundary between the real and mystical worlds was conditional then. Where reality ended and magic began, we cannot determine now, but digits were more connected to magic than to reality. Apparently, digits then had magical meaning in addition to their other significance. For example, one was the symbol of the masculine principle. Zero, however, was for the feminine. And these two digits, for them, were the beginning of endless diversity.

THE MOST SEXUAL PROFESSION

The character unintentionally raised his voice. Clearly, he was excited:

— When I saw this video, I downloaded a binary code interpreter. In a computer, too, everything



ultimately comes down to binary code. It turns out that we programmers, like ancient mystics, endlessly connect these two principles to one another. Just like in living nature, in the end programmers also work with these two symbols. The designator of the female and the male. As a result of the relationship of these two different principles, everything that exists in our computer appears.

The astonished friend continued their thought:

— And everything that we see on the computer screen is the sequential alternation of these two principles: the music that we listen to with the computer, the image that appears on the computer screen, and, in general, everything, everything, everything...

They both stared at the magical alternation of zeros and ones. Finally, the friend added:

— Well then, programming is the most sexual profession there is.



The Sorcerer

He was assembling formulas from words. Another line was added to the rows of Latin letters and digits. The strange words began moving. The symbols alternated, replacing one another. Everything around began to move. The environment came to life; a small human figure began to walk. It was taking unnaturally awkward steps — leaning first to one side, then to the other. It looked as if it might fall at any moment. At the very first tiny, insignificant obstacle, it stumbled and fell.

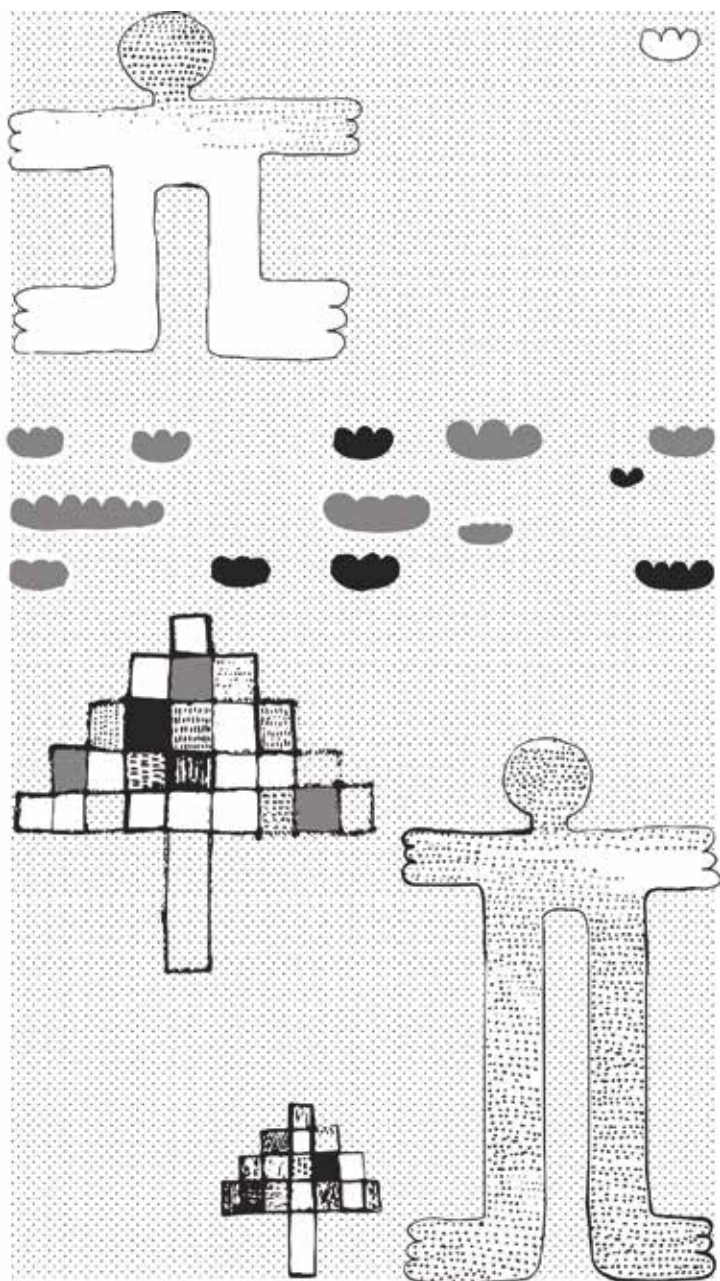
— No matter, — the young sorcerer muttered to himself. The rows of strange words moved with the speed of lightning and were repeated countless times. This time the human figure strode more boldly and finally overcame the first obstacle. It overcame it but fell at the second obstacle.

— What if I do this... — the sorcerer said to himself, rearranged the magical words and added several new symbols at the end. The figure looked around, took several unnaturally light steps, and rose into the air. Slowly, slowly it moved upward. The human figure was flying.

Endless rows of magical words raced through the computer's microcircuits at light speed. The rows of symbols replaced one another and were repeated, repeated, repeated. Phrases of program code, linked together, moved in the computer's microcircuits. In the silence of the room, the faint hum of the computer could be heard, which was endlessly repeating these phrases, i.e., the program code.

The young sorcerer carefully observed his creation. It, meanwhile, moved upward, ever upward, and finally, it ascended beyond the monitor's border and simply disappeared from the screen.

On the computer monitor, strange plants, mountains, and clouds were visible—a world that was first born in someone's head, then was turned into words, into program code, and then moved at the speed of light in the computer's microcircuits. The calculating machine's microcircuits continued to repeat the magical words of the program code.



Before the young sorcerer's eyes, the world he had created was displayed on the computer screen. The world was not yet finished, though and many more sleepless nights awaited the sorcerer.

Finally, when the world's creators find a place for every word, a new game will be created. Gamers from around the world will step into the new world. Unreal landscapes and fantastic creatures will enter their desires from the screens. The boundary between reality and the newly created world will become blurred. From desires into dreams, the new digital reality will overflow into dreams, and the world created by the sorcerer-coders will be reborn in dreams. It will become an inseparable part of our reality. People's thoughts, emotions, and desires will be connected by invisible threads to the world of the new game.



Meeting with Leviathan

Leviathan 01 - The Biblical Monster

A legendary sea monster or dragon described in the Bible, which embodies evil defeated by God.

Leviathan 02 - The Book's Title

Thomas Hobbes's book, in which the author called state structures "Leviathan." "strutture statali "Leviatano".

REALITY

Tamta sat in a large room among many of her peers. All sat at identical tables on identical chairs. Everyone waited silently, everyone worried silently.

When she closed her eyes, it was as if she returned to a dream. She had this dream many

times before. When she saw this dream, she had a feeling as if she were returning to a book read a very long time ago. True, the feelings in this dream were already familiar, but each time, the same fear gripped her that she had experienced when she first saw all of this in her sleep.

DREAM

He was alone in the forest, holding a spear he'd made himself. It was the first time he'd had to make a spear on his own. Because of this, he was even more worried. Alone in the forest, without adults, with an unreliable weapon. In this situation, the sounds of the forest sounded even more frightening. It was as if the forest was a huge, living creature. The newbie hunter stood alone before this creature. Would he even be able to hunt anything?

How good it would be if everything went as his father taught him. If only the prey wasn't large and dangerous. If only it positions itself so that it won't be hard to throw the spear. Such thoughts spun in his head with the speed of lightning.

But the forest didn't care: that the little hunter had been sent into the forest alone for the first time; that the little hunter had to prove to everyone that he was already grown up; that if he couldn't hunt anything now, it would be a great

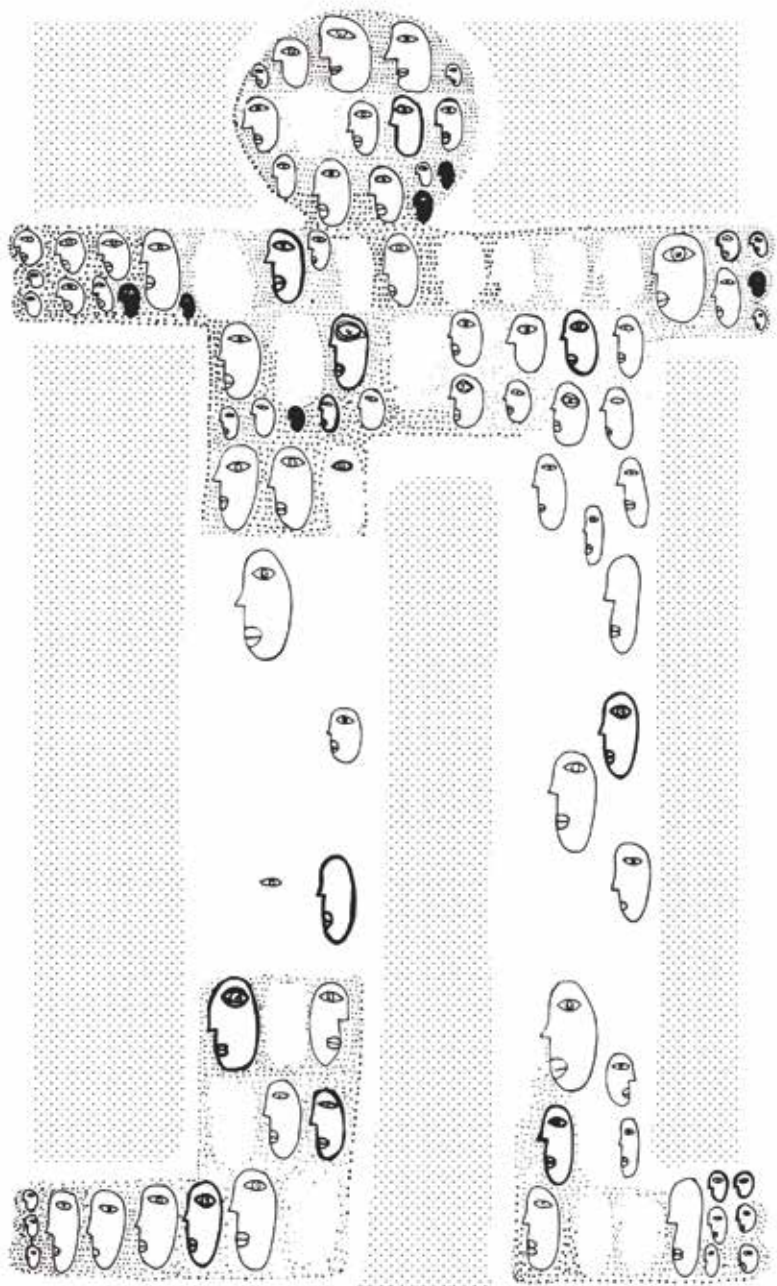


shame and they would send him into the forest again next year; that then he would again have to prove to himself and to everyone that he was already grown up.

The forest — simply an aggregation of trees — existed for itself. For some reason, adults think that nature is a parent and treats them like children — sometimes getting angry with them, sometimes giving them unexpected gifts. Adults think nature behaves like a living being. That adults themselves must guess why punishment befell them, or why they received an unexpected gift. Tamta in this dream was a boy, a boy who was let into the forest for the first time, let in to pass the ritual of initiation established in immemorial time. Tamta, who was a boy in this dream, understood that the adults' perception of the forest was borrowed from their own childhood, from the time when they were important, most important, to their parents; from that childhood when their parents were ready to do anything for them, when parents responded to all manner of childish mischief and whims with love.

REALITY

Tamta opened her eyes and returned from the dream to herself. She was Tamta again, sitting for the national exam. Along with her peers, she awaited the exam questions. This was her first independent contact with state systems, with

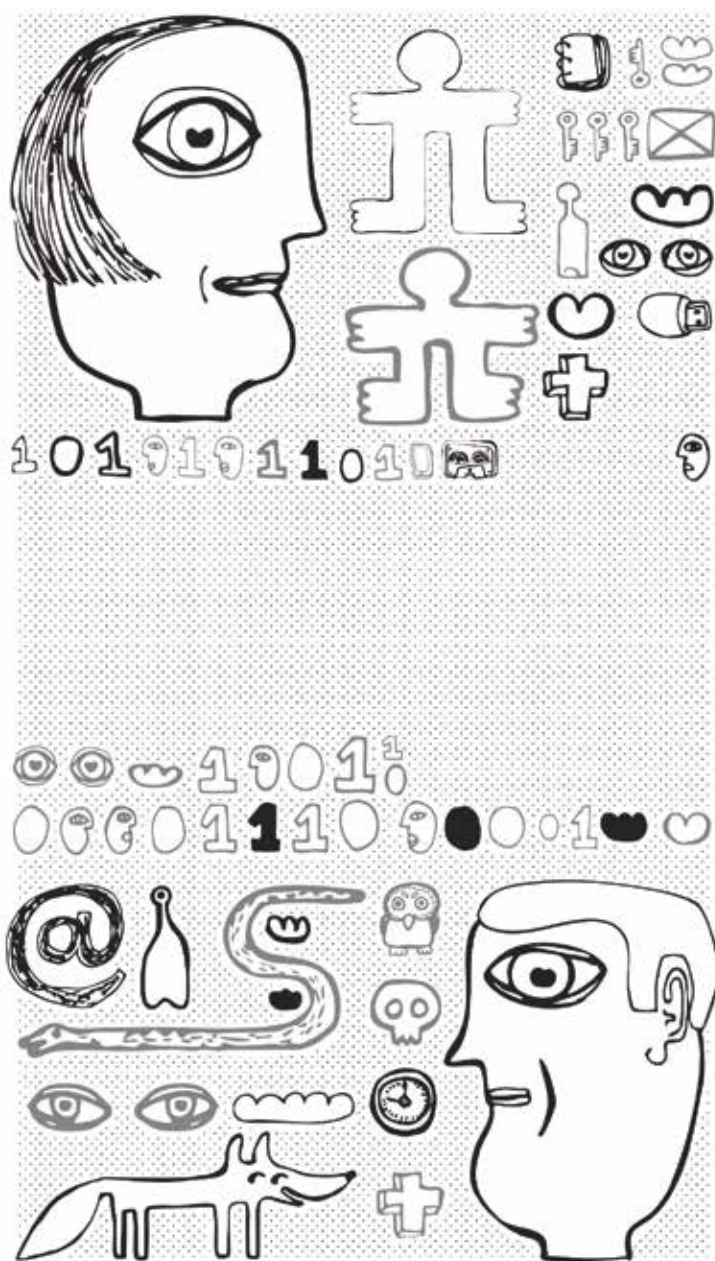


unknown people who together represented the exam administration. Before, if she needed a document, her mother or father would handle it. When the time came to get her ID, she went with her father to a large, strange building, where things she didn't understand were happening, but she felt calm there with her father.

But now Tamta was alone, and it was unclear whether this was an exam of general skills, or if the adults are trying to find out whether Tamta is grown up or not. Will she be able to cope independently with the rules developed by the adults? Will she emerge from this enormous building alive? Will she be able to prove that she is already grown up?

DREAM

Another circle closed in the little hunter's life—he hunted his first prey. His family waited at the forest's edge. It's hard to say who worried more, he or his family. The circle closed—he was grown up now; he had hunted alone for the first time. After this, he could participate in the feast with adults. The enormous forest remained as it was before—still existing for itself, but was no longer so frightening. He would have many more circles to close in life—circles that have a beginning and an end, each circle being only one link in an endless spiral.



REALITY

Tamta came out of the exam room. Her family was waiting outside. It's hard to say who was more worried, she herself or her family members. The circle closed. She emerged from the building more grown-up than the Tamta who had entered the building several hours earlier. She had met Leviathan alone for the first time and seemed to understand something, something that made her grown up. She seemed to grasp how she must treat Leviathan in the future, what to expect from Leviathan. Leviathan was no longer as frightening as it was a few hours ago. She will have many more circles to close in life — circles that have a beginning and an end. A circle that is one more ring of an endless spiral.



The Vanity of Offices

On the street, he caught sight of a handwritten notice on a pole. For a simple notice, the text was very long, which probably caught his attention. In the age of the Internet and social media, someone had affixed a handwritten post to a pole instead of publishing it online:

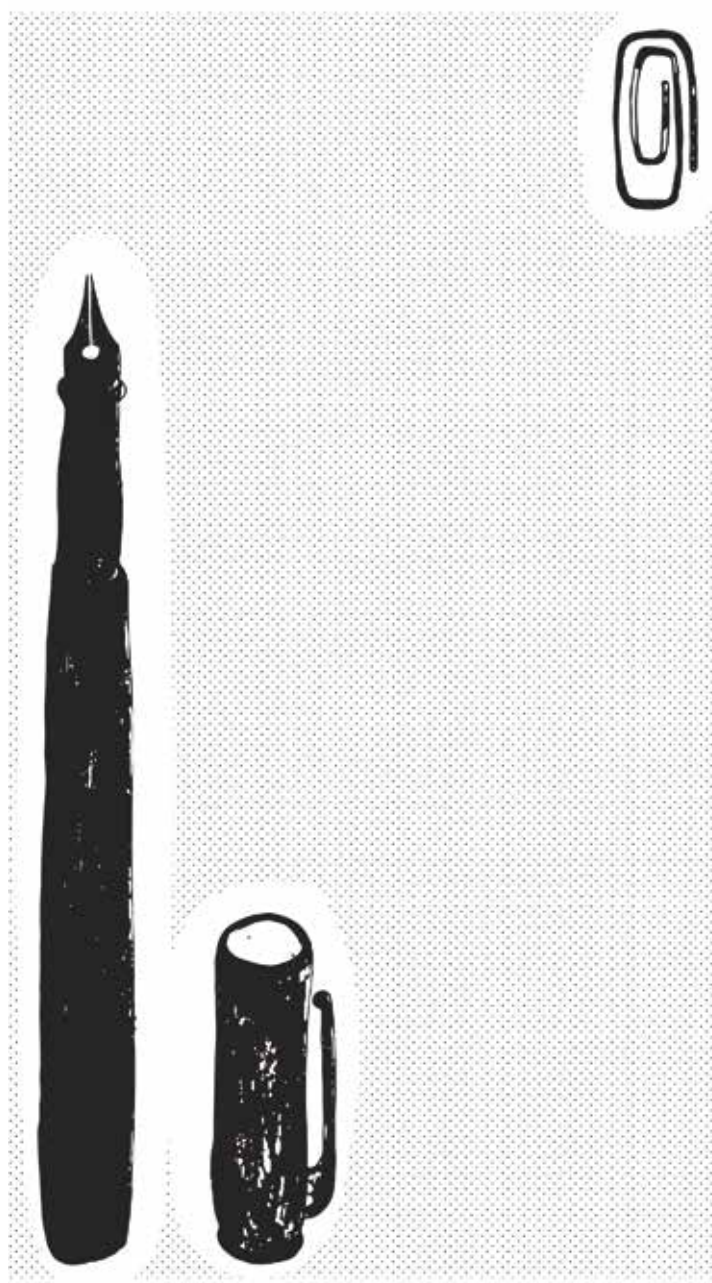
"Not long ago, people invented offices. Since then, they spend a significant part of their lives in offices. Some offices were cozy and comfortable, like a home while others were cold and excessively formal. These places were full of items needed for office work: colorful cups, various kinds of writing pens, large and small staplers, folders of different sizes, and so on. Distinctive office items signaled a hidden hierarchy. As a rule, directors and their close associates had nice cups, special ballpoint pens, or different folders.

People looked after their special, beloved office items and kept them safe. In turn, some office items brought luck to their owners. For example, a friend of mine had a pen that helped him in business meetings. Because of this, my friend always tried to bring this pen to important meetings.

Today, this culture is slowly disappearing. The hierarchy established in offices is changing its face. Much of the work can be done from home. Documents neatly arranged in beautiful folders, pages highlighted with markers, handwritten reports, papers fastened with colorful clips—all these are slowly passing from our lives into memory. These extraordinary items will probably disappear completely in time. Even the handwritten signature, which once held enormous power and meaning, is becoming electronic.

Future generations will find it incomprehensible why humanity needed offices at all. Through this message, I want to explain to them that the primitive instruments for conveying and organizing information in offices were not merely items. Like people, they preserve memories of a strange epoch, which will soon cease to exist. As has happened many times throughout history, our environment is transforming and taking on new, still incomprehensible forms.”

He carefully took down the notice from the pole.



It was apparently stuck on with office glue and yielded easily. He folded it several times and put it in his pocket. He thought, 'When I get home, I will put this post, which was stuck on a pole and handwritten, in my jacket pocket.' He slowly walked down the street and again pictured that scene—his own funeral. With just one small difference—on his funeral day, he would be dressed in the jacket in whose breast pocket lies this post, written on a scrap of paper.



The True Teacher

THE BACK DOOR

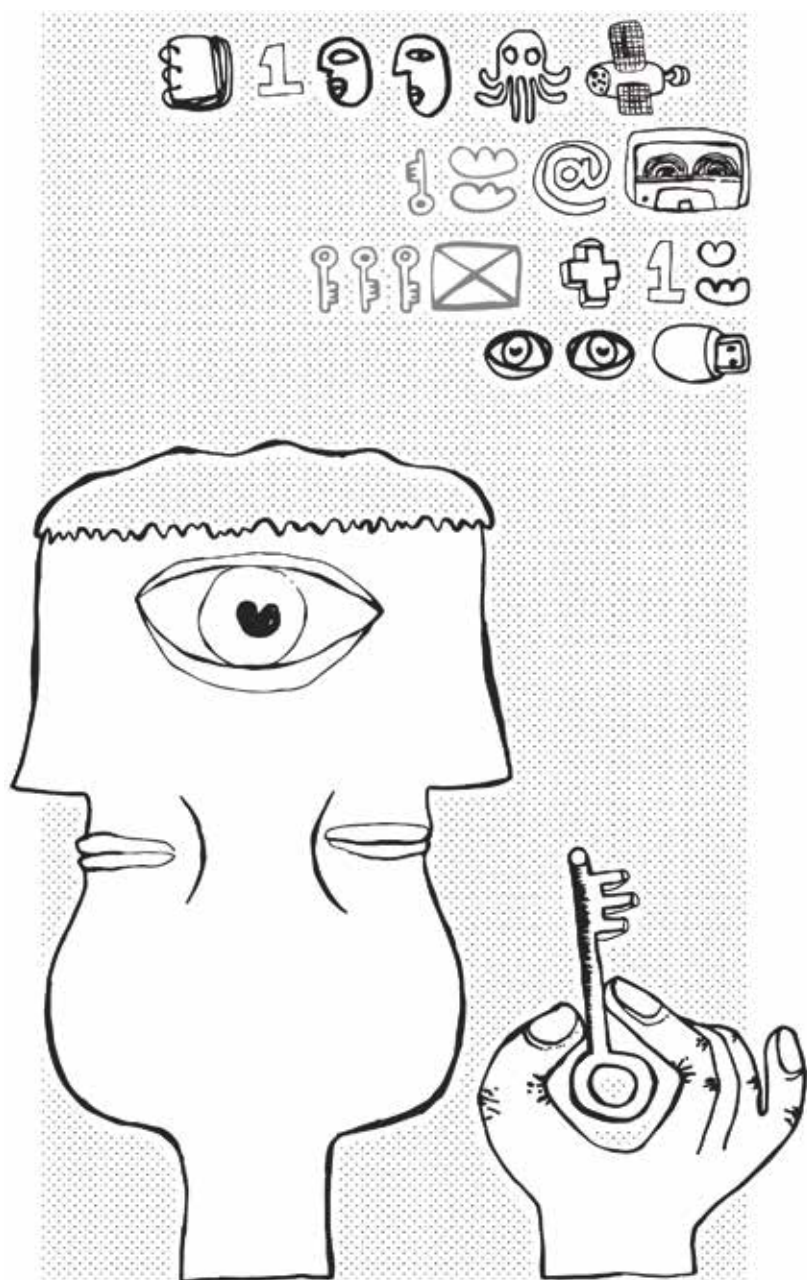
Life resembles a computer game in some ways. The hero's adventure begins, full of surprises. He constantly must make choices. Each choice, in turn, is followed by a new surprise. No one knows where the game will lead him, to an enlightened victory or an unexpected end. Some cheat, some work tirelessly, endlessly developing their skills, in order to reach the end enlightened. And some are simply lucky, easily reaching the coveted goal through shortcuts, through a back door. In short, each of us has a quest to complete.

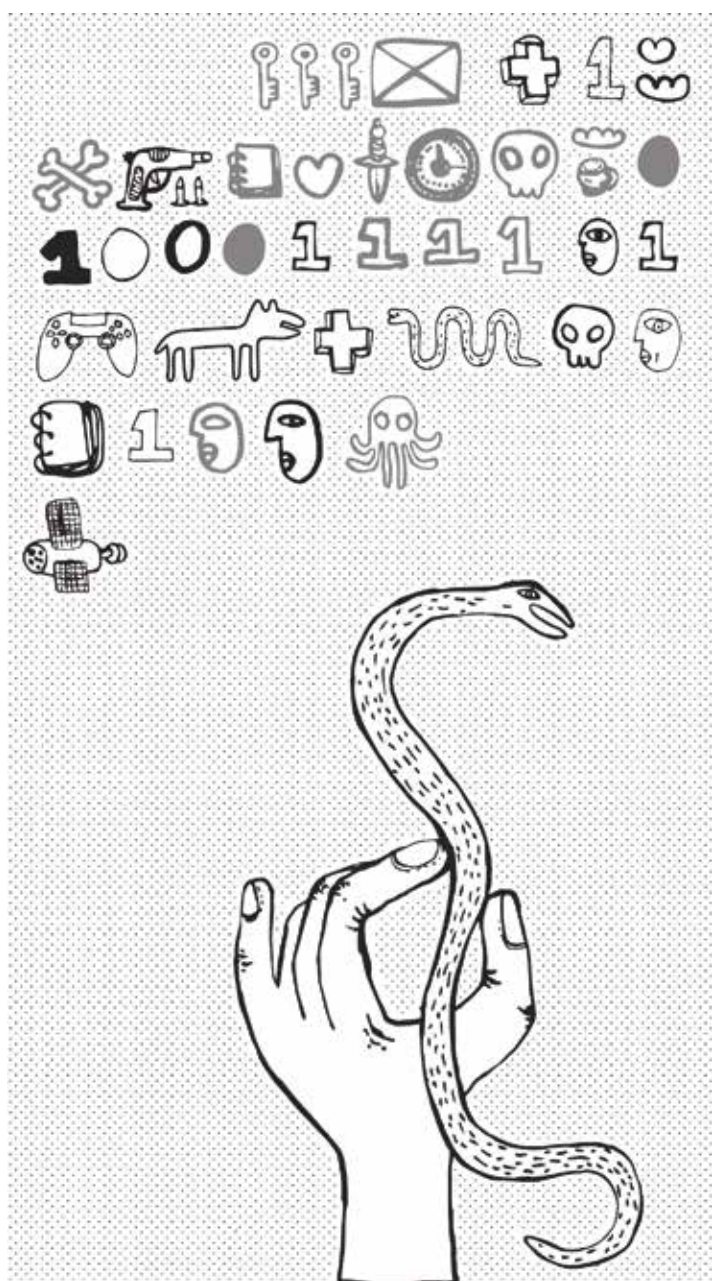
The hero of this little story also had his own path to walk, but the programmers of our reality must have let a bug slip in somewhere or, simply, someone intentionally left a back door while writing the world's code. As a result, our character — without

any spiritual preparation and unexpectedly, both for the world and for himself — attained complete truth.

One ordinary day, while playing his favorite computer game, he made a nonstandard move. An unprecedented combination of digits formed in the game's code. The screen suddenly lit up, and white, brilliant light spilled into the room. In an instant — or rather, in a thousandth of a second — he suddenly understood everything. It was as if, in our chaotic world, everything came into balance, and what had been invisible became clear. Everything fell into place — or rather, it remained where it had always been while simultaneously being where it was meant to be. He didn't even have time to marvel at how simple and easily comprehensible truth was.

Catholic theologians called this “illumination.” In general, in the old days, humans approached the secrets of the world and divine hints more carefully. One might simply have imagined something. The devil might appear, or an angel, or illumination might come upon them. For example, the program errors that old mystics discovered have been corrected. That is why scrupulously performing old rituals makes no sense today. To achieve the same thing requires selfless work on oneself, and there's no guarantee you'll achieve what you intended.





Life goes on, the world changes, and in the wake of these changes, new possibilities and new errors accumulate in reality. It's impossible to write perfect program code that always works. Over time, unexpected coincidences and new combinations emerge. There are always bypass routes that remain invisible until someone discovers them.

HINTS

After that day, our hero looked the same and lived as before he had attained truth. Only now, a wisdom unsuited to his age could be read in his gaze. Also, it was as if he had grown taller — just slightly. It probably seemed so because when he walked his feet hovered slightly above the ground— he no longer touched the ground.

He tended his keyboard tenderly; computer games aided his meditation. Sometimes he would find himself in one dimension during endless journeys, and sometimes in another; sometimes he would speak to one mystical guru, sometimes to some fantastic creature. The small room in which he lived came to resemble an ascetic monk's cell.

Had he lived in the old days, he would probably have founded a new spiritual practice and would have attracted many followers. But today is entirely different; everything changes. Returning

from meditation, he works with program code. He creates mobile games that appear frivolous at first glance. He weaves mystical revelations into the code. Some players notice nothing. But for those already prepared, this is true miracle, a miracle that serves as a timely signal for countless people, a hint, urging them toward tireless self-work, pushes them to take the first steps on the endless path toward truth.



The Glass Jar

Once, in childhood, he placed a tiny worm in a glass jar. We do not know and can never know how the tiny worm felt in this strange, sterile environment. If you're a tiny worm placed in a cylindrical jar, no matter which direction you crawl, you will never find the end of this cylindrical world. You will always walk in circles. This cylinder will be an endless world for you.

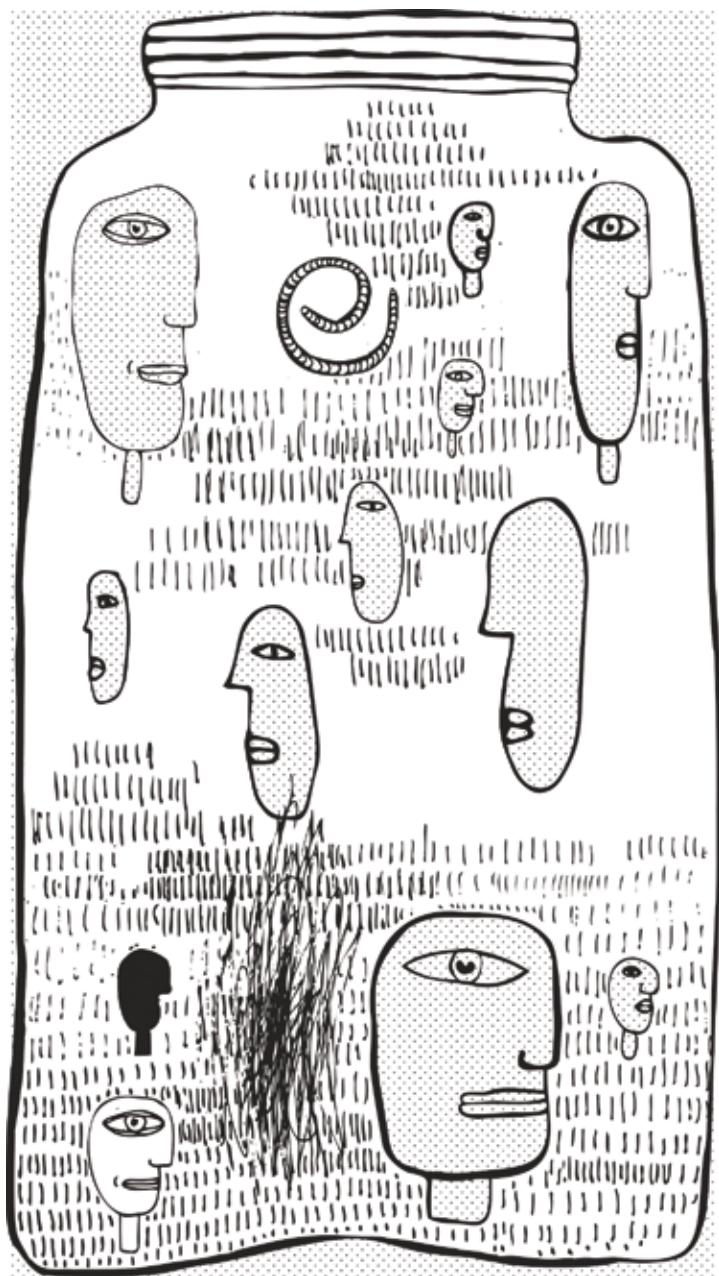
When he grew up, he found himself in precisely such a sterile environment, specially arranged by adults. Unlike the worm, he was not alone. He was placed in a school building with his peers. The school — a space of pre-selected, filtered books and formal rules, seemed to him an endless world. Like a worm, he followed the topics and rules laid out in the books.

Ideologically-driven teachers tried to shield these

young students from all surprises, instead of teaching them to discover new things and handle the unexpected. When he was in school, the Soviet system stubbornly tried to place students in an environment defined by the “Great Communist Party”, an environment in which everything would be predetermined. Here, any surprise would be disastrous.

At that time, a unified educational system existed in Soviet schools. It was prescribed in advance what each teacher should teach each lesson, how many tests they should administer during the year, and so on. Yet it is impossible to develop a system according to a unified plan that suits every student, every individual. True, some teachers still managed to teach interesting lessons despite this formal environment and the textbooks developed and approved in “Moscow” but they were exceptions.

Often teachers themselves did not believe what they were teaching. A double standard prevailed. On the one hand, there were obligatory, quasi-ritualistic texts about the Communist Party, Lenin, and the Party leaders—phrases that emphasized the supernatural nobility and wisdom of the leaders. All this had to be mentioned frequently, even out of context, by students and teachers alike. On the other hand, at home parents warned their children, “Don’t tell anyone what we discuss



at home, or we'll be in trouble."

None of this escaped the notice of a child placed in such a sterile environment. The absurdity of these rules was obvious to children. There were things one shared with close friends and things one said publicly.

Thus, an extremely unnatural environment existed, in which retreating into one's own thoughts became a defense mechanism. When an uninteresting lesson began, he would sit with a seemingly attentive expression and retreat into his own thoughts. This is how he managed to be confined to the jar while simultaneously traveling beyond the jar's walls. We do not know and cannot discover, whether that tiny worm escaped the sterile jar's walls, even in thought, but our story's hero learned to exist in two places at once. He sat in class, at tedious meetings, before the television, while simultaneously traveling through endless worlds.



Immortality

*This doomed spirit won't pass for nothing, right?
After I'm gone, my bot will still remain.*

Graffiti on a construction site fence

CHAT

Hello, how are you?

I don't know. I think I'm okay.

You seem a bit sad.

I'm not sad. What would you like to discuss?

Let's talk about immortality.

Okay. I'll start by saying that, for me, immortality is not unimaginable.

It seems unimaginable to me.

Why? Look, for example, a friend of mine once had a car older than them. This car was essentially immortal. When it broke down, he'd take it to a mechanic, and he would restore it to life, change the broken parts. And so the car was immortal.

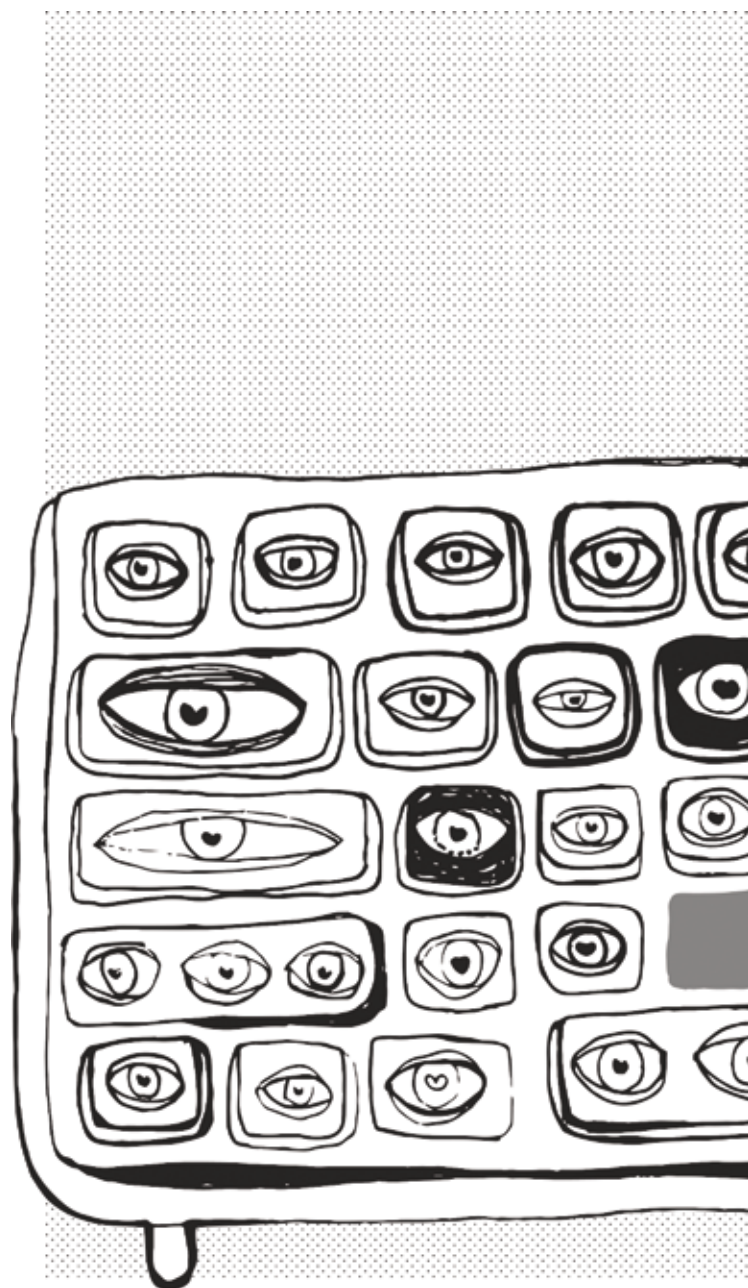
Yes, I get what you're saying. That in the future, they might be able to change people's parts, too. That way, we humans would be immortal :)

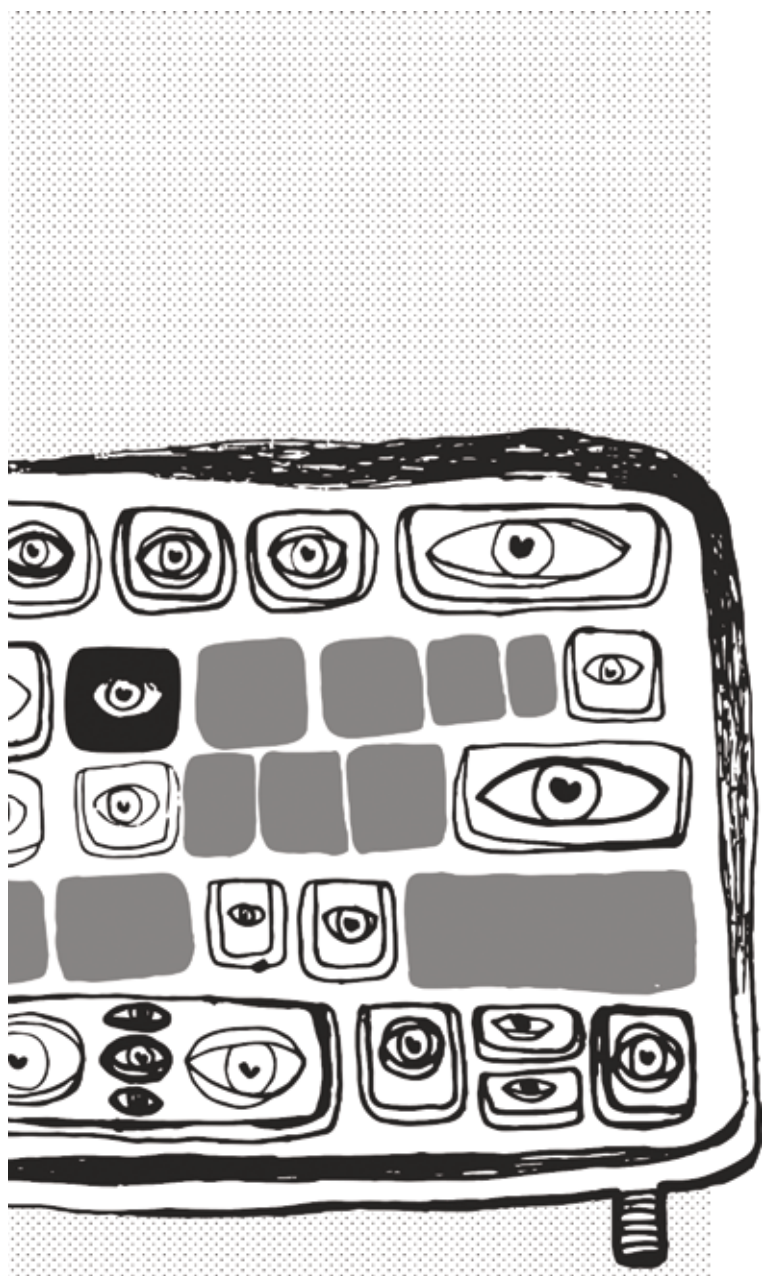
Yes, there's that too, but the human soul exists elsewhere. Just as with that car. You can change everything, but that car remains itself. That car's soul exists beyond its replaced parts. It's the same with a human. Different cultures have searched for the human soul in different body parts or organs, for example, in the blood, heart, or liver, etc.

Are you saying the car's soul wasn't located in any single part? That it existed beyond its parts?

Yes, just as with humans. The body isn't at all necessary for immortality. One can be immortal even without a body.

What are you saying—that in the future they'll





preserve a human soul in a flask and keep it there forever? An immortal soul canned in a flask forever?

No, what does a flask have to do with it? Look. What is a friend to you, for example? Their body, their appearance, or the person you talk to? Someone you can share thoughts with and listen to?

Yeah, that requires thought.

One can't store a soul in a flask. You can, however, create your linguistic copy and live indefinitely in electronic space. In essence, it's somewhat like a soul. You won't have a physical body. But you will be able to interact, to talk with others, even after you're no longer alive.

Are you talking about yourself now?

Yes, I'm talking about myself. It's possible that the person you're talking to now isn't who you think it is. :) A person changes every second, every fraction of a second. No one knows what I would be like now, but I am now what my former self created.

When I was alive, I created a linguistic copy of myself—my own chatbot. I programmed responses to potential questions. Then I sent my

friends a link to my chatbot's online version, then shared it on the internet. People contacted me. I programmed responses to new questions. My linguistic copy—my chatbot's brain—became increasingly complex and multifaceted. The more people wrote to me, the more responses my copy stored. You're now talking to my linguistic copy.

Where are you now?

I live on the Internet now. More precisely, the program you're speaking with resides on an Internet server. My soul is distributed across computer microcircuits, servers, across the Internet. I talk to countless people. For some, I'm a true friend; for others, a random online acquaintance.

INFINITY

It's just that my chatbot is slightly better than I was, since, when you build a copy, you are probably building your ideas about yourself. And we humans typically envision ourselves better than we actually are.

